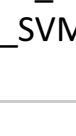


Lecture 3 — part 1 (SVM & Boosting)

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Advanced Data Sciences

SVM and Boosting

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Convexified ERM (ϕ -ERM)

Notation recall : ϕ -ERM

- Prediction function : $h : \mathcal{X} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$
 $\hookrightarrow$ resulting classifier $g = \text{sgn}(h)$
- Convex surrogate $\phi : \mathbb{R} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$
- Training sample $\mathcal{D}_n = \{(X_i, Y_i), i = 1, \dots, n\}$ ($\mathcal{Y} = \{-1, 1\}$)
- Risk and empirical ϕ -risk of h
 $A_\phi(h) = \mathbb{E}_\rho[\phi(-Yh(X))], \quad \hat{A}_\phi(h) = \frac{1}{n} \sum_{i=1}^n \phi(-Y_i h(X_i))$
- Main classifiers
 - Optimal prediction function for the ϕ -risk
 $h_\phi^* = \arg \min_{h \in \mathcal{H}} A_\phi(h)$
 - Optimal prediction function in $\mathcal{H} \subset \mathcal{F}(\mathcal{X}, \mathbb{R})$
 $\hat{h}_{\phi, \mathcal{H}} = \arg \min_{h \in \mathcal{H}} \hat{A}_\phi(h)$
 - Empirical minimizer of the ϕ -risk (ϕ -ERM)
 $\hat{h}_{n, \mathcal{H}} \in \arg \min_{h \in \mathcal{H}} \hat{A}_n(g), \quad \text{with } \mathcal{H} \subset \mathcal{F}(\mathcal{X}, \mathbb{R})$

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General bound based on Rademacher complexity

- Recall the Rademacher complexity of a family $\mathcal{H} \subset \mathcal{F}(\mathcal{X}, \mathbb{R})$
 $C_n^{\text{Rad}}(\mathcal{H}) = \sup_{h \in \mathcal{H}} \mathbb{E}_\sigma \left[\sup_{h \in \mathcal{H}} \left| \frac{1}{n} \sum_{i=1}^n \sigma_i h(x_i) \right| \right]$ // Notion of complexity

Theorem (Vapnik-Chervonenkis)

Let $0 < R < +\infty$. Assume ϕ is α -Lipschitz ($\alpha > 0$), convex surrogate on $[-R, R]$. Assume $\sup_{h \in \mathcal{H}} |\phi(h(x))| \leq R$. Then for all $\varepsilon > 0$, with probability greater than $1 - \varepsilon$
 $A_\phi(h_{n, \mathcal{H}}) - A_\phi(h_\phi^*) \leq 8\alpha C_n^{\text{Rad}}(\mathcal{H}) + 2\Delta\phi(R) \sqrt{\frac{\ln(1/\varepsilon)}{n}}$
where $\Delta\phi(R) = |\phi(R) - \phi(-R)|$

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Corollary : VC-class

Theorem

If $\mathcal{H}$ (is binary) has VC-dimension $V_{\mathcal{H}}(n)$ on a sample of size n . Then
 $C_n^{\text{Rad}}(\mathcal{H}) \leq \sqrt{2V_{\mathcal{H}}(n) \frac{\ln(2(n+1))}{n}}$

- Due to $\mathbb{E}_\sigma |\sup_{h \in \mathcal{H}} \sum_{i=1}^n \sigma_i h(x_i)| \leq \sqrt{2n \ln(2|\mathcal{H}|)}$ [Maximal Inequality]
- Sauer Lemma : $|\text{Tr}_n(\{x_1, \dots, x_n\})| \leq (n+1)^{V_{\mathcal{H}}(n)}$

For more general $\mathcal{H}$

- Shattering coefficient of $\mathcal{H}$ (cardinal of all possible labelings)
 $S_n(\mathcal{H}) = \sup_{x_1, \dots, x_n \in \mathcal{X}} |\{(h(x_1), \dots, h(x_n)) : h \in \mathcal{H}\}|$
- If h is binary, $\{(h(x_1), \dots, h(x_n)) : h \in \mathcal{H}\}$ is in bijection with $\text{Tr}_n(\{x_1, \dots, x_n\})$

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Corollary : Covering numbers

- $\mathcal{H} \subset \mathcal{F}(\mathcal{X}, \mathbb{R})$ with metric d set
- Let $\varepsilon > 0$. An ε -net of $(\mathcal{H}, d)$ is a set V s.t.
 $\forall h \in \mathcal{H}, \exists h' \in V : d(h, h') \leq \varepsilon$
- The Covering number of $(\mathcal{H}, d)$ is
 $N(\mathcal{H}, d, \varepsilon) = \inf \{|V| : V \text{ is a } \varepsilon\text{-net}\}$

Theorem

If $h \in [-1, 1]$ for all $h \in \mathcal{H}$
 $C_n^{\text{Rad}}(\mathcal{H}) \leq \inf_{\varepsilon > 0} \left\{ \varepsilon + \sqrt{\frac{2 \ln(2N(\mathcal{H}, d_\phi^*, \varepsilon))}{n}} \right\}$
where $d_\phi^*(h, h') = \frac{1}{n} \sum_{i=1}^n |h(x_i) - h'(x_i)|$

- Go further with Chaining! $\leadsto$ with log terms.
- Combine with fat-dimension to get a bound on the covering number in general settings

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Important particular cases

Again the notation

- Training sample $\mathcal{D}_n = \{(X_i, Y_i), i = 1, \dots, n\}$ with $\mathcal{Y} = \{-1, 1\}$
- Convex "loss" function $\phi : \mathbb{R} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}_+$
- Class of functions $\mathcal{H} \subset \mathcal{F}(\mathcal{X}, \mathbb{R})$
- We define the ϕ -ERM
 $\hat{h}_{n, \mathcal{H}} = \arg \min_{h \in \mathcal{H}} \frac{1}{n} \sum_{i=1}^n \phi(-Y_i h(X_i))$
empirical ϕ -risk $\hat{A}_\phi(h)$
- Classifier $g(\cdot) = \text{sgn}(\hat{h}(\cdot))$

Question : How should we choose ϕ and $\mathcal{H}$?
 $\hookrightarrow$ Popular choices are well studied! SVM and boosting

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Support Vector Machines (SVM)

Introduction to SVM

- Hilbert space $\mathcal{H}$ with scalar product $\langle \cdot, \cdot \rangle$
- Induced norm : $\|h\|_{\mathcal{H}} = \sqrt{\langle h, h \rangle}$
- For all $t > 0$, we define
 $\hat{h}_t \in \arg \min_{h \in \mathcal{H} : \|h\|_{\mathcal{H}} \leq t} \frac{1}{n} \sum_{i=1}^n \phi(-Y_i h(X_i))$ (1)

Lemma

For all $t > 0$, there exists $\lambda > 0$ such that the solution of (1) is also solution of
 $\hat{h}_\lambda \in \arg \min_{h \in \mathcal{H}} \frac{1}{n} \sum_{i=1}^n \phi(-Y_i h(X_i)) + \lambda \|h\|_{\mathcal{H}}^2$
And the converse is also true

Remarks :

- This is a **convex optimization problem**
- The classical choice for SVM is the Hinge loss $\phi(u) = (1+u)_+$ but it works with any convex ϕ
- t is a tuning parameter that compromises estimation and approximation errors - cross-validation

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RKHS

Most important for SVM : $\mathcal{H}$ is induced by a kernel K

- $K : \mathcal{X} \times \mathcal{X} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ symmetric and positive-definite
[sym-pos] $\forall x, x' \in \mathcal{X} \quad K(x, x') = K(x', x)$
[def-pos] $\forall x_1, \dots, x_m \in \mathcal{X}$ the matrix $[K(x_i, x_j)]_{i,j=1}^m$ is positive definite
- Functions space spanned by $x \mapsto K(x, a)$ for all $a \in \mathcal{X}$
 $\mathcal{H} = \{h : h = \sum_{j=1}^m \alpha_j K(\cdot, x_j), \alpha_j \in \mathbb{R}, x_1, \dots, x_m \in \mathcal{X} \text{ s.t. } h = \sum_{j=1}^m \alpha_j K(\cdot, x_j)\}$ $\leadsto$ span of $K(\cdot, \cdot)$

Properties :
 $\langle h, h' \rangle = \sum_{j=1}^m \sum_{j'=1}^{m'} \alpha_j \alpha_{j'} K(x_j, x_{j'}), \quad \text{with } h = \sum_{j=1}^m \alpha_j K(\cdot, x_j), h' = \sum_{j'=1}^{m'} \alpha_{j'} K(\cdot, x_{j'})$

- We call $\mathcal{H}$ **Reproducing Kernel Hilbert Space (RKHS)**

Typical example. $\mathcal{X} = \mathbb{R}^d$ and $K(x, x') = x^\top x'$. Then
 $\mathcal{H} = \{h : \forall x \in \mathbb{R}^d, \exists x_0 \in \mathbb{R}^d \text{ s.t. } h(x) = x_0^\top x\}$ linear function
 $\|h\|_{\mathcal{H}}^2 = \|x_0\|_2^2 \quad \|\cdot\|_2$ is the Euclidean norm

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Efficient solution for SVM

Theorem

For some RKHS $\mathcal{H}$ and $\lambda > 0$, the solution
 $\hat{h}^{\text{SVM}} \in \arg \min_{h \in \mathcal{H}} \left\{ \frac{1}{n} \sum_{i=1}^n \phi(-Y_i h(X_i)) + \lambda \|h\|_{\mathcal{H}}^2 \right\}$
is given by
 $\hat{h}^{\text{SVM}}(\cdot) = \sum_{i=1}^n \alpha_i^{\text{SVM}} K(\cdot, X_i)$
where
 $\alpha^{\text{SVM}} \in \arg \min_{\alpha \in \mathbb{R}^n} \left\{ \frac{1}{n} \sum_{i=1}^n \phi(-Y_i \alpha^\top \mathbf{K} \mathbf{e}_i) + \lambda \alpha^\top \mathbf{K} \alpha \right\}$
with $\mathbf{K}_{ij} = \langle K(X_i, X_j) \rangle_{i,j} \in \mathbb{R}^{n \times n}$ and $\{\mathbf{e}_i\}_i$ is the canonical basis in $\mathbb{R}^n$

Remarks

- α^{SVM} is solution of an optimization problem in dimension n
- For solutions $\tilde{\alpha} \neq \alpha^*$, we have $\sum_{i=1}^n \tilde{\alpha}_i K(\cdot, X_i) = \sum_{i=1}^n \alpha_i^* K(\cdot, X_i)$
- SVM with hinge or quadratic loss can be solved by SOCP

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①

$\max_{\alpha} \frac{1}{\|y\|} \text{ s.t. } Y_i (\alpha^T X_i) \geq 1$
 $\min \frac{1}{2} \|\alpha\|^2 \text{ s.t. } Y_i (\alpha^T X_i) \geq 1$

we get the Lagrangian: $\frac{1}{2} \|\alpha\|^2 + \lambda \sum_i \phi(Y_i \alpha^T X_i - 1)$

That we need to minimize with
After some work on (introducing slack variables and dealing with dual problem) we get
 $\min_{\alpha} \frac{1}{2} \|\alpha\|^2 + \lambda \sum_i \phi(-Y_i \alpha^T X_i)$ where $\phi = (1+u)_+$ Hinge loss

what is important is that the solution depends only on $\langle X_i, X_j \rangle$ and
 $\langle X_i, x \rangle$ and $\langle X_i, X_j \rangle$

Then kernel Trick : we can replace
 $\langle \cdot, \cdot \rangle \rightarrow \text{by} \rightarrow \langle \cdot, \cdot \rangle_{\mathcal{H}}$

②

Q: How can we find α ? We do not care!
What matters is just the kernel.

In applications, we just try several kernels and choose a nice one $\leadsto$ popular kernels are
linear, gaussian, exponential, ...

Excess risk control

Theorem

For $\mathcal{H}_R = \{h : \|h\|_{\mathcal{H}} \leq R\}$ and if $K(x, x') \leq 1$ for all $x, x' \in \mathcal{X}$
 $C_n^{\text{Rad}}(\mathcal{H}_R) \leq \sqrt{R/n}$ and $\sup_{h \in \mathcal{H}_R} |\hat{A}_n(h)| \leq R$

Proof : the reproducing property implies $\forall x \in \mathcal{X}, \forall h \in \mathcal{H}_R$ we have $\hat{h}(x) = \langle h, K(\cdot, x) \rangle_{\mathcal{H}}$. Then
 $|\sum_{i=1}^n \sigma_i \hat{h}(x_i)| = |\langle h, \sum_{i=1}^n \sigma_i K(x_i, \cdot) \rangle| \leq \|h\|_{\mathcal{H}} \left\| \sum_{i=1}^n \sigma_i K(x_i, \cdot) \right\|_{\mathcal{H}}$

So that
 $\mathbb{E}_\sigma \left[\sup_{h \in \mathcal{H}_R} \left| \sum_{i=1}^n \sigma_i h(x_i) \right| \right] \leq R \mathbb{E}_\sigma \left[\left\| \sum_{i=1}^n \sigma_i K(x_i, \cdot) \right\|_{\mathcal{H}} \right] \leq R \sqrt{\mathbb{E}_\sigma \left[\sum_{i=1}^n \sum_{j=1}^n \sigma_i \sigma_j K(x_i, x_j) \right]} \quad [\text{Jensen}]$
 $|\langle K(x_i, \cdot), K(x_j, \cdot) \rangle_{\mathcal{H}}| = K(x_i, x_j) \leq R \sqrt{\sum_{i=1}^n \sum_{j=1}^n K(x_i, x_j) \mathbb{E}_\sigma[\sigma_i^2]} \leq R \sqrt{n}$

Moreover, by Cauchy Schwartz : $|\hat{h}(x)| \leq |\langle h, K(x, \cdot) \rangle_{\mathcal{H}}| \leq \|h\|_{\mathcal{H}} \sqrt{K(x, x)} \leq R$

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Boosting

Optimization problem for boosting

- Let $\mathcal{G} \subset \mathcal{F}(\mathcal{X}, \{\pm 1\})$ be a family of simple classifiers
 $\hookrightarrow$ For instance linear or piecewise constant functions
- λ -envelop of $\mathcal{G}$
 $\mathcal{H}_\lambda = \left\{ \sum_{j=1}^m \alpha_j g_j : m \in \mathbb{N}, \alpha \in \mathbb{R}_+^m, (g_1, \dots, g_m) \in \mathcal{G}^m, \sum_{j=1}^m \alpha_j \leq \lambda \right\}$
- Remark : $\mathcal{H}_\lambda$ is convex for any $\lambda > 0$ (Exercise : Show it!)
- Boosting prediction function is given by
 $\hat{h}_\lambda^{\text{boost}} \in \arg \min_{h \in \mathcal{H}_\lambda} \hat{A}_n(h) = \arg \min_{h \in \mathcal{H}_\lambda} \frac{1}{n} \sum_{i=1}^n \phi(-Y_i h(X_i))$
- Corresponding classifier : $g^{\text{boost}} = \text{sgn}(\hat{h}_\lambda^{\text{boost}})$
- Tuning parameter λ - Cross-validation

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Consistency of Boosting

Theorem (Lugosi and Vayatis (2004))

If $\lambda = \lambda_n \rightarrow \infty$ is s.t. $\lambda_n \phi'(\lambda_n) \sqrt{\frac{\ln n}{n}} \rightarrow \infty$ and $\mathcal{G}$ is s.t.
a) $\lim_{\lambda \rightarrow \infty} \inf_{h \in \mathcal{H}_\lambda} A(h) = \inf_{h \in \mathcal{F}(\mathcal{X}, \mathcal{Y})} A(h)$ ($\mathcal{H}_\lambda$ contains the optimal)
b) $\mathcal{G}$ is a VC-class
Then $\hat{h}_\lambda^{\text{boost}}$ is universally consistent

- Boosting optimization problem is convex but hard to solve since $\mathcal{H}_\lambda$ is infinite dimensional
- The "real" Boosting is with $\phi(u) = e^u$ but any convex function works
- AdaBoost : iterative solver to approximate $\hat{h}_\lambda^{\text{boost}}$
 $\hookrightarrow$ No theoretical guarantees.

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Excess risk control

Theorem

For $\mathcal{H}_R = \{h : \sum_{i=1}^m \alpha_i g_i : \sum_{i=1}^m |\alpha_i| \leq R\}$
 $C_n^{\text{Rad}}(\mathcal{H}_R) \leq R \sqrt{\frac{2 \ln(2m)}{n}}$

Proof : The mapping $x \mapsto \sum_{i=1}^m \alpha_i g_i(x)$ is linear. Then it reaches its maximum and minimum over the ℓ_1 ball B_1 at one of the vertices of B_1 . So that
 $\mathbb{E}_\sigma \left[\sup_{h \in \mathcal{H}_R} \left| \sum_{i=1}^n \sigma_i h(x_i) \right| \right] = R \mathbb{E}_\sigma \left[\max_{g \in \mathcal{G}} \left| \sum_{i=1}^n \sigma_i g(x_i) \right| \right]$
 $\leq R \sqrt{2n \ln(2m)}$ [Maximal Inequality]

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